ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	116th Commission Meeting
DATE:	08 February 2023
TIME:	03:00 PM
VENUE:	Dasho Chairperson's Chamber

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSIONS	DECISIONS
1.	**Regular HR update – HRS** *The HRO apprised the following decisions of the 86th HRC meeting:* *a) Request to reconsider the stipend rate for the ongoing Corrupt Practices Investigation Course in Singapore by the two candidates in view of it not being adequate to meet the basic minimum expense against the very high costs of living. The Commission noted that while the financial aspect of the training is an issue for the candidates, the content of the course and the opportunity to strengthen the institutional linkage would be very useful for the individuals as well as the institution.* *b) Feedback of the mandatory training and its related follow-up works including review of the mandatory course by a Taskforce in the future and immediate action to plan other training based on CBF.* *c) Sonam Choden, IPO's appeal to change the placement from Trashigang to Thimphu in view of her father's health.* d) *Yoezer Dolma's Expression of interest to*	**The Commission noted the HRC's decisions. Further specific directions were as follows:** **The Commission supporting the decision of the HRC, directed HRS/AFS to write a letter to the Ministry of Finance to seek their special approval to cover the accommodation charges of the candidates, in addition to the admissible monthly stipend. The letter to make reference to the past approval and indicate the costs to be borne from the ongoing ADA project.** **Directed HRS to expedite the planning of training for intermediate and advanced levels, based on CBF.** **The Commission directed HRS and relevant departments to ensure the genuineness of any such appeals given the current manpower challenges in the region. The particular transfer was supported given the health of her father.**

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	pursue further studies *e) Nominations for Training on Performance Compliance and Audit Compliance* *f) Rinchen Namgay's application for extension of Extraordinary Leave* *g) Ms. Dorji Dema, IPO, DoI has expressed her interest to go to the Bumthang Regional Office*	**Further, directed HRS to review the staff strength of regional offices vis-à-vis the approved strength and accordingly facilitate filling the gaps.**
2.	**Apprise issues related to ZESt-ADS integration in view of the structural changes – ADMD** *ADMD apprised that following the structural changes effected by the Pay Structure Reform Act of Bhutan 2022, the Royal Civil Service Commission (RCSC) as of now has not updated the changes in the ZESt system. Since the Asset Declaration System and ZESt are integrated, the auto-populated data against the Agency and Department of declarants will be incorrect. In addition, the RCSC is planning to update the ZESt around end of April 2023. As the asset declaration for the income year 2022 is in the offing, waiting for the RCSC to update its ZESt will cause unnecessary delay in the declaration period. To this, the Division proposed if individuals should be made to manually fill in their Agency and Department for the upcoming asset declaration to ensure data pertinent to declarant's working agency are accurate and the AD is filed on time.*	**The Commission endorsed ADMD's proposal to adhere or stick to the asset declaration period by asking the individuals concerned, especially those who are affected by the structural changes, to update their details correctly during the declaration. Directed ADMD to ensure proper updation of changes without errors by working in close collaboration with the ADAs of the relevant agencies. To this, the details updated by the individual declarant will require to be verified by the ADAs. The changes were directed be made based on the revised lists of agencies shared by the Cabinet Secretariat.** **Other specific directives of the Commission related to ADMD were:** • **To plan sensitization for the ADAs of the agencies that are affected by the structural reform.** • **Plan the way forward on operationalizing lifestyle watch in consultation with PD and PPD.**
3.	Others: - Discuss sharing of information on case status to the head of agencies	**Directed CFD, DoI and LD to discuss and propose a way forward on streamlining the gap in information sharing, particularly with regard to closed cases. The Commission suggested**

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		sharing copy of the prosecution referral/suspension with relevant agencies to keep them informed. The proposal was directed to be reported in the next Commission meeting.
	- Standard correspondence format for sharing of letters within and outside	**Considering the inconsistencies in the minutes/letter/correspondence reviewing and signing practices, the PPD was directed to develop a protocol to ensure standard practice in the ACC. The protocol to also include necessary actions required for using eversign and google documents.**
	- Way forward on Model Public Service Code of Conduct	**Directed Prevention Division to plan the implementation and sensitization of Model Public Service Code of Conduct in consultation with ED, PPD, and other relevant Divisions/Departments. The Commission noted that while a public advisory on the adoption of the respective Code of Conduct may be encouraged till June 2023, it will have to be enforced starting July 2023 to all the public agencies.**
	- Revision of Gift Rules 2017	**The Legal Division was directed to prioritize revision of Gift Rules 2017 in keeping all the feedback and comments received by all the Departments/Divisions in various forums, including Thematic Sessions of the DoPE. While trying to simplify the procedures, the revision should also bring greater clarity on managing gifts received as *soelras.***

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**

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